RudCo: Company Profile

Status: Approved by Ken, 2026-10-10.

Researched 2026-10-10 from public pages only. Where a fact came from a search-result snippet and not from a page I read, it is marked (**snippet only**). Text in quotation marks is exact wording I read on the linked page.

What matters to them

Section 1

- **Documents travel with the material.** RudCo's site sells "PO→COA/MTR" traceability (a purchase order tied to a certificate of analysis and a mill test report) and "DFARS/REACH/RoHS flags" (FAQ text in the site code). Their own pages say each shipment's certificates and country-of-origin records are tied back to the PO, lot and heat number. Our compliance-flag step (mill test reports, country of origin, spec certifications) is the thing they already promise customers.
- **Buyers can see a fair price.** Their LinkedIn page says "Opacity is a tax on industrial procurement." (RudCo LinkedIn post, 2026-04-20). Another post asks "Have you ever wondered if you're getting the right rate?" (post, 2026-05-11). A price shown next to a named benchmark, with a reason, matches how they talk.
- **Quotation intake is a named pain.** In the founder's Digital Journal interview, procurement teams may spend time requesting quotations by email, and he believes automation can help "organize routine work such as quotation intake" (see the article). Their company page says "Procurement is still on email." (post, 2026-08-25). This track is their stated problem, not a side exercise.
- **AI supports the person; it does not replace them.** Founder quote: "People still want to deal with people, especially when the decision is important" and "Technology can handle more of the coordination and give those people better

information for the conversation." (Digital Journal, 2026-08-21). This fits our rule that the rep approves every quote.

- **Speed and trust together.** The site's tagline is "Precision. Transparency. Trust." (site code). The FAQ promises "Stocked lines ship in 24–48 hours" (same file). The Columbia listing calls the offer "Fast, simple and easy material supply." (Columbia directory).
- **They are very small.** LinkedIn's company data lists 3 employees (RudCo LinkedIn page, structured data). The person judging you is probably the founder or someone close to him, and the right hire for a three-person company is someone who ships a working thing.

Company

Section 2



RudCo's home page share image, from rud-co.com.

- **What it is.** Legal name The Ruddock Company LLC; trades as RudCo (site metadata, `legalName` field). Website: rud-co.com. The site is a Lovable-built

single-page app (the page source references lovable.dev), so every URL returns the same shell and the text lives in the JavaScript bundle.

- **One-line description, two versions.**
  - Columbia directory: an "industrial supply company that streamlines procurement for the metal, abrasive and aggregate space" aiming to supply raw materials to "America's largest manufacturing companies" (Columbia Entrepreneurship directory). The directory text has a typo ("provide and provide"), so it looks lightly edited.
  - LinkedIn: "a sourcing and supply company for American critical material supply chains, powered by AI" that sources and delivers "critical materials to defense and industrial buyers, with an AI platform that streamlines the purchasing workflow and identifies chokepoints before they become shortages" (RudCo LinkedIn page, structured data). The company's story has moved from "metal, abrasive and aggregate" toward "critical materials for defense and industrial buyers."
- **Location.** New York, NY. The site's structured data lists a business address of 69 Charlton St., 10014 (site metadata). That is the same address Devpost gives for Columbia Startup Lab, where this hackathon runs (Devpost map link). It suggests RudCo works out of or near the Lab; no source says so outright.
- **Stage.** Early. Columbia lists it with no stage, funding or headcount (directory). LinkedIn lists 3 employees (LinkedIn). I found no funding round, investor, accelerator or revenue figure. The privacy policy has an effective date of Dec 18 2024 (site code), so the company has existed since at least late 2024.
- **Posting history.** The LinkedIn company page has posts from April to September 2026 on tariffs, aluminum smelter capacity, near-shoring, critical minerals and AI infrastructure (LinkedIn page, structured data). The most recent I could see is 2026-09-14, titled "The Great AI Shortage" (post).
- **Possible link to an older company.** N.T. Ruddock Company of Cleveland, OH has sold blasting abrasives since 1951 and also sells aluminum ingot, master alloys and pure metals (N.T. Ruddock About page). Search snippets show a Sam Ruddock as "global markets director" there in a 2022 Thomasnet piece (**snippet only; Thomasnet returned 403 to me**). I could not confirm that this is the same person or how the two companies relate. Treat it as unverified.

Team

Section 3

Public professional information only.

- **Sam Ruddock, founder.** The Columbia listing says "Founded by Sam Ruddock, Columbia Business School" (directory). His public LinkedIn page shows RudCo as current work, location New York City area, and Columbia Business School from 2023-05 to 2025-05 (LinkedIn profile, public structured data). Several earlier roles and schools are masked in the public view, so I can't list them. The Digital Journal piece says he "views this gap through his experience in industrial materials and distribution" (article). The snippet-only N.T. Ruddock role (above) would fit that, but is unconfirmed.
- **Others.** LinkedIn's company data says 3 employees but names none (LinkedIn page). The site has no team page. A LinkedIn profile for a Jim Ruddock lists RudCo (**snippet only; the profile returned an error to me**); I did not confirm his role.
- **Who judges.** Devpost lists one judge, Somya Gupta, with no affiliation shown (Devpost). The page says the founders "write the challenges, walk the floor and judge the demos," so Sam Ruddock is likely on the floor. That is an inference.

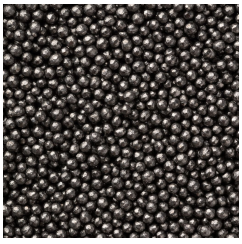
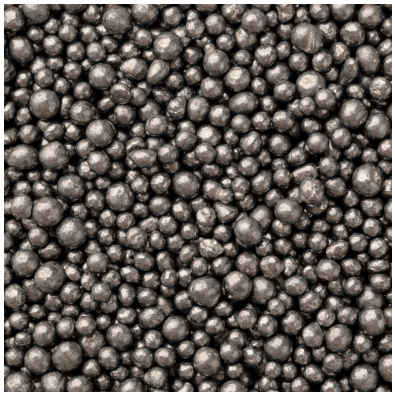
Business model and customers

Section 4



The platform page's share image, from rud-co.com.

What they sell, as pictured on their product pages:

Steel shot	Stainless steel shot	Garnet	Aluminum oxide
			

Product photos from rud-co.com.

What they sell. The site lists abrasives (steel shot and grit, garnet, aluminum oxide, corn cob, glass bead, stainless abrasives) and metals (primary aluminum P1020, 356 alloys, titanium, steel billets and plate, copper cathode, master alloys, fluxes, ferro alloys) (site code). A recycling page covers scrap aluminum and spent abrasive media.

How they make money. They look like a software-enabled supplier: they source from producers and smelters and sell to manufacturers, with a web front end on top. Evidence:

- Their terms speak of "placing an order," "receiving a quote," invoices and past-due charges, so RudCo itself sells and invoices (terms text in site code).
- The metals page says primary aluminum comes "from multiple smelters" with COA/MTR on every shipment (same file), which is a reseller or program-supply position.
- The founder describes "a technology-supported procurement model designed to organize pricing, availability, and fulfillment information" and work that includes "providing data and information, sourcing and supplying" materials, plus logistics and recycling (paraphrase from Digital Journal).
- The site claims a portal with product search, "real-time availability," "dynamic pricing," and ordering "directly through the portal." The product schema on the pages shows a price of "0" and in-stock for every item (site code), which reads as placeholder data. I did not log in or test the portal, so treat the portal claims as marketing until seen.
- A quote request is a four-step form that promises a reply "within 24 hours" (site code). Business hours are listed as Monday to Friday, 7:00 AM to 8:00 PM EST. A real person still builds the quote today.

Who buys. The site lists energy and oil/gas, foundries, machine and fabrication shops, OEMs and heavy manufacturing, paint and coatings prep, pipe and tube, and steel mills (site). LinkedIn says customers "range from $2M to $10B in revenue across defense primes, aerospace, automotive, and construction" (LinkedIn page). That is RudCo's own claim. I found no named customer, and the site's one case study link ("How Steel Mill Reduced Costs 22% with Smart Procurement") points to a placeholder.

In their own words

Section 5

All of these are public and attributed. Nothing here is from a private source.

- **Founder, Digital Journal, 2026-08-21** (article):
  - "Supply chains and distribution are really about data and how that data is managed"
  - "A buyer needs to understand pricing, supply, inventory, and transportation well enough to make a sound decision quickly."
  - "Those practices can make it difficult to compare available options or respond promptly when conditions change"
  - "People still want to deal with people, especially when the decision is important"
  - "Technology can handle more of the coordination and give those people better information for the conversation."
  - The article also says Ruddock "believes automation can help organize routine work such as quotation intake, freight coordination, invoicing, and order tracking" (this is the writer's paraphrase, not his quote). It says aerospace and defense need "specialized grades, predictable delivery schedules and documentation that follows a material through the supply chain" (also the writer's words).
- **Founder, LinkedIn, 2026-08-25:** "I've spent the past while building RudCo, and it's been the most interesting work of my career." (post)
- **Company, LinkedIn, 2026-04-20:** "Opacity is a tax on industrial procurement." and "The cost doesn't show up as price. It shows up as friction." (post)
- **Company, LinkedIn, 2026-05-11:** "The market moves every day. The quote in your inbox often doesn't." (post)
- **Company, LinkedIn, 2026-08-13:** the founder is "building RudCo" to solve "American critical mineral sourcing, powered by AI that maps and de-risks

supply chains in real time." (post). The first-person phrasing is "That's the problem I'm building RudCo to solve."

- **Website:** "Industrial materials simplified." and "Precision. Transparency. Trust." (site code).

I found no podcast, conference talk, video or longer press piece beyond the Digital Journal interview.

Hiring

Section 6

- **Open roles: none found.** The site has no careers page (rud-co.com). LinkedIn company data shows no jobs section I could read. Three web searches for RudCo jobs returned nothing about this company.
- **Context.** Hackathon framing says the participating startups "are hiring" and that "Your project is your interview" (Devpost). Prize: "Interview Slot," 1 winner. So the role is unstated; the hiring signal is the hackathon itself.
- **What they likely want (inference from their writing, not a posting).**
  - Someone who works on the real problem end to end: buyer emails in, a quote out. The challenge text says "Today a person decodes every line by hand."
  - Someone who handles uncertainty honestly. Devpost requires that you "Show how it handles uncertainty: what it does when it isn't sure."
  - Someone who understands the founder's view that the human stays in the loop.
  - With three people, someone who can build and explain without a team around them.

Competitors

Section 7

None of these were named by RudCo. They are the groups it would be compared with.

- **Traditional distributors.** N.T. Ruddock (above) for abrasives and aluminum ingot. Steel shot and grit makers and their distributors: Winoa (W Abrasives) and Metal Tech are named on RudCo's own FAQ as the brands its steel shot is "a direct alternative" to (site code). SurfacePrep carries Ervin Industries and W Abrasives (**snippet only; SurfacePrep**).
- **Digital metals marketplaces.** Metalshub, a Dusseldorf marketplace for metals and ferroalloys that raised an $11 million Series A in 2021 and charges the seller a fee on traded value (**snippet only; Acton Capital**). NowPurchase, an Indian marketplace for metal manufacturers' raw materials (**snippet only; CB Insights**); its site describes it as "Transforming Procurement & Production for Factories" (nowpurchase.com).
- **Where RudCo says it differs.** It pairs sourcing and delivery with an AI layer, and it sells "critical materials" to defense and industrial buyers (LinkedIn page). I did not find a direct competitor doing the same RFQ-to-quote job for metals in my searches, but I did not search deeply for one.

What this means for our demo and pitch

Section 8

How the RFQ track maps to their business: RFQs are how RudCo's buyers ask for price, and the founder names email quote intake as manual work. A faster, more accurate quote helps a three-person supplier handle more buyers without more staff.

- **Show the compliance flags early.** Documents and traceability are the most repeated selling point on their site. Make the mill test report, country of origin

and spec certification flags easy to see on the first screen of the demo.

- **Show the benchmark next to every price.** "Opacity is a tax" is their phrase. A price with a named benchmark and a one-sentence reason answers it directly. Label the data as sample data on screen, as the brief commits to.
- **Keep the rep in charge.** Their founder says people stay central and technology gives them "better information for the conversation." Our "draft, rep approves, buyer questions go out" flow says the same thing. Use that framing in the pitch: the agent prepares the conversation, the rep has it.
- **Lean on "ask, don't guess."** It matches both the Devpost rule on uncertainty and the founder's point about specialized grades. A clarifying question that offers the buyer a choice (16 gauge or 0.060 in) shows you understand real buying.
- **Use their materials.** Their catalog is steel shot, abrasives, aluminum alloys, titanium, copper cathode and steel plate. The Devpost example is stainless sheet, which is outside their listed range. Mix at least a few RudCo-style lines (steel shot S-330, P1020 ingot, aluminum 356) into the test RFQs so the demo looks like their business. The catalog sizes and grades named on their site are in the site code.
- **Mention speed in their terms.** They promise a reply within 24 hours and shipping in 24 to 48 hours for stocked items. A quote draft in minutes fits that story.
- **Keep it a working product.** Three people, builder-minded. Devpost rejects "thin wrappers that pass a prompt to a model and print the result." A demo that shows correct line parsing and an honest "no match" beats a wide feature list.

Gaps

Section 9

What I could not find, and where I looked.

- **Funding, revenue, customers by name, hires, founding date.** Searched the Columbia directory, rud-co.com, LinkedIn company and founder pages, and general web search. None had them.

- **Job postings.** Three searches (company name with job terms, LinkedIn, general) found nothing. The site has no careers page. LinkedIn's jobs tab was not readable without signing in.
- **Founder background beyond Columbia.** LinkedIn's public view masks earlier employers and schools. I did not sign in. The N.T. Ruddock role comes from search snippets, because Thomasnet blocked fetches (403), so it is unconfirmed.
- **The portal.** I did not create an account or test the platform, so "real-time availability" and "dynamic pricing" are untested claims.
- **Transcripts, podcasts, talks.** Searched for the company and founder name with interview and podcast terms; only the Digital Journal piece and LinkedIn posts exist.
- **A few pages I could not fetch.** The Thomasnet article and profile (403) and a federal capabilities-statement site that search results listed (rud-cogov.com; the domain did not resolve for me). Both are snippet-only.
- **Devpost oddities.** The Devpost page says "Using NicrronNinoo and Block Convey is a must in your project" in two places. I don't recognize these names and found no explanation on the page. Worth asking the organizers or the team lead before the submission is final.
- **Judge identity.** Only one judge is named, with no affiliation.
- **Searches run (all web search tool unless noted).** RudCo + Sam Ruddock; rudco.com RFQ; Sam Ruddock Columbia; The Ruddock Company LLC; Sam Ruddock LinkedIn; Get Hired Hack + RudCo; N.T. Ruddock history; RudCo careers (twice); Digital Journal title; Sam Ruddock + global markets; RudCo + podcast/interview; metals procurement competitors; steel shot competitors. Direct fetches: Columbia directory page, Devpost page, rud-co.com and its JavaScript bundle, ntruddock.com/about, LinkedIn public pages for Sam Ruddock and RudCo, Digital Journal article, nowpurchase.com. The Reddit site was not used.

Sources

Section 10

- Columbia Entrepreneurship startup directory: RudCo
- RudCo website and its page script containing the site text
- RudCo on LinkedIn (company description, employee count, posts)
- Sam Ruddock on LinkedIn (public profile data; post: 2026-08-25)
- RudCo LinkedIn posts: Opacity is a tax (2026-04-20), right rate (2026-05-11), critical minerals (2026-08-13), email procurement (2026-08-25), Great AI Shortage (2026-09-14)
- Digital Journal: AI infrastructure boom reshapes industrial materials procurement (2026-08-21)
- Get Hired Hack on Devpost
- N.T. Ruddock Company, About
- NowPurchase
- Snippet only: Thomasnet N.T. Ruddock profile, Thomasnet article, Acton Capital on Metalshub, CB Insights on Metals Hub competitors, SurfacePrep W Abrasives
- Product brief: PRD